

HANDHELD GAMING CONSOLES BACK IN ACTION WITH THE SWITCH

Paromik Chakraborty

Remember the good-old days of playing Super Mario sitting in your car? The cult handheld gaming consoles of the 1990s and 2000s are back with a new life, creating a stir among the gamers once again. Packed with modern features and awesome games to play, here is how the handheld gaming consoles look today.

Nintendo Switch

The design and appearance of Nintendo's 2017 offering are without a doubt quite impressive. While the Nintendo Switch is a 15.7cm (6.2-inch) touchscreen tablet, the gamepad is its main USP. The gamepad comes in the form of two detachable Joy-Con controllers for left (L) and right (R) controls. You can either lock these onto the two edges of the Switch screen or use as a separate system.

The box comes with a Dock, which can connect the system to a TV screen or monitor for gameplay. So



(Image source: Nerdist.com)

essentially, the portable handheld system can convert into a proper gaming console off-the-shelf, which justifies its moniker Switch. The device can be plugged out of the monitor and the play resumed without requiring restart or even pause.

Switch packs an impressive internal memory of 4GB, which can be expanded by a microSD card up to a massive 2TB (although microSDs above 256GB are rare in the market). Connectivity modes include HDMI, Wi-Fi, USB as well as Bluetooth 4.1. The battery life is quite decent, offering three to six hours of straight gameplay with Wi-Fi turned on. While the gadget is not powerful enough to run very high-end 4K games, developers have rolled out some impressive features.

Exclusive classic titles like Super Mario, Mario Kart, Ultra Street Fighter,

Splatoon along with the latest iterations from popular global series like *The Legend of Zelda: Breath of the Wild* have enticed gamers to buy this device. The game library is limited for Nintendo at the moment, which somewhat affects the price as well. However, with expanding reach of the device, we can expect better games at cheaper costs. Nintendo Switch costs ₹ 25,000 onwards.



Nintendo Switch